

◆ COP31 QATAR PAVILION

Side Events Programme

📅 09-20 November 2026

📍 Antalya, Türkiye



Welcome to the Qatar Pavilion

The Qatar Pavilion at COP31 serves as a platform for dialogue, innovation and collaboration, bringing together policymakers, experts, researchers and international organizations to advance climate action and sustainable development.

Through a series of side events, the Pavilion highlights practical solutions, knowledge exchange and partnerships supporting the global climate agenda.

MECC Climate Change Efforts

in 2026, we documented a year of tangible progress in advancing Qatar's national climate action agenda through the development of strategic policies, the strengthening of institutional capacities, and the expansion of international engagement. The Ministry's efforts reflected to translate national priorities into practical outcomes aligned with the Paris Agreement, the Third National Development Strategy (NDS-3), and Qatar National Vision 2030.

During the 2024–2026 period, the Ministry's efforts focused on five key areas. Among the most significant achievements was the official launch of Qatar's first National Adaptation Plan (NAP), which provides a comprehensive, evidence-based roadmap to enhance climate resilience across six priority sectors and several cross-cutting areas. In parallel, the foundations were established for an integrated national climate transparency framework to support the tracking of Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs), facility-level greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions reporting, and the future deployment of AI-enabled digital solutions.

The period also witnessed progress in strengthening Qatar's Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs) by increasing ambition, enhancing data reliability, and broadening stakeholder engagement, while linking mitigation, adaptation, and means of implementation with long-term development pathways.

Capacity-building initiatives and international cooperation further elevated Qatar's profile and presence in global climate processes, including participation in Conferences of the Parties (COPs), the organization of national pavilion events, and engagement in high-level dialogues. These efforts enhanced institutional readiness and strengthened Qatar's international visibility.

Collectively, these achievements demonstrate how effective coordination, strong governance, and strategic partnerships can translate climate ambition into tangible and measurable impact.

Looking ahead, these efforts highlight a clear trajectory for Qatar: from planning to implementation, from national priorities to global engagement, and from ambition to achievement. In doing so, it reinforces Qatar's position as a credible and proactive contributor to international climate action while strengthening resilience and sustainability at the national level.

Key Highlights & Impact

Launch of the National Adaptation Plan (NAP)



9 Reports

on Climate Vulnerability and Impact Assessment in the Six Key Sectors of Qatar



6 Sub-Reports

incorporated into the final NAP Report.



3 Workshops/Events

were delivered.



6 Sectors

Collection of adaptation measures across 6 sectors through stakeholder questionnaires

COP30 Amazonia Presence



5 Side Events

were designed including concept notes, talking points, and graphic design materials 21+ (since 2022)



25+ Speakers and Moderators

were mobilized. 65+ since 2022



Climate Negotiations

Active participation.

Knowledge Products and Reports



13 Knowledge Products

delivered (27 since 2022).

Policies Drafted



3 Policies

delivered (14+ since 2022).

National Adaptation Plan

NDC 3.0

Qatar's National Climate Transparency System Report

Capacity Building Workshops



10 Capacity Building Workshops

were delivered.

Regional and International Participations



8 regional and international meetings, conferences, and events

in which MECC participated.

Ministry of Environment and Climate Change Strategy 2024-2030

“Together Towards a Sustainable Environment for a Better Future.”

Overview: The strategy aims to support environmental sustainability, striking a balance with development needs. It further aims to enhance Qatar’s ability to adapt to climate change, protect the environment and conserve its natural resources. To achieve these goals, the strategy focuses on consolidating both institutional and societal cooperation, in addition to capitalising on general environmental awareness among the wider population.

4 Key Pillars of Strategy



Environmental Sustainability and Climate Change

- Protection of environment and biodiversity
- Effective management of climate change
- Boosting environmental and sustainability practices



Innovation and digital transformation

- Support research, innovation, and digital transformation to promote sustainable development.



Governance

- Development and implementation of policies and legislations



Sustainable institutional development

- Strengthening institutional capacities
- Strengthen community participation and collaboration

Side-Events Calendar

#	Title	Theme	Date/Time
01	From Planning to Delivery: Implementing National Adaptation Plans at Scale	Adaptation and Resilience	Nov 10 13:00 → 14:00
02	MRV Systems for Implementation and Accountability	Energy Transition and Mitigation	Nov 12 13:00 → 14:00
03	From Ambition to Action: Implementing NDCs in the Decisive Decade	Climate Finance and Implementation	Nov 14 13:00 → 14:00
04	Data, Digitalization, and AI for Climate Implementation and Decision-Making	AI and Climate Technology	Nov 16 13:00 → 14:00
05	Challenges of National Communications Reporting for Developing Countries	National Collaboration	Nov 18 13:00 → 14:00

◆ Side-Event 1

From Planning to Delivery: Implementing National Adaptation Plans at Scale

Theme: Adaptation and Resilience

NOV. 10 2026 | 13:00 → 14:00

As countries move beyond the formulation of National Adaptation Plans (NAPs), the emphasis is increasingly on implementation, delivery, and impact. Translating adaptation priorities into concrete actions requires effective governance, financing mechanisms, coordination across sectors, and systems to track progress. This panel discussion explores how countries are advancing NAP implementation in practice, highlighting challenges, enabling conditions, and lessons learned.

◆ Agenda

- Opening Remarks — 5 mins
- Panel Discussion — 40 mins
- Q&A session with audience — 10 mins
- Wrap-up and conclusion — 5 mins

◆ Speakers



**Eng. Ahmed
Mohamed Al Sada**

Assistant Undersecretary for
Climate Change Affairs
Ministry of Environment and
Climate Change (MECC) – Qatar



**Eng. Saad
Al Hitmi**

Director of Climate
Change Department
Ministry of Environment and
Climate Change (MECC) – Qatar



**Ms. Fatma
Varank**

Deputy Minister



**Ms. Rohini
Kohli**

UNDP

◆ Side-Event 2

MRV Systems for Implementation and Accountability

Theme: Energy Transition and Mitigation

📅 NOV. 12 2026 | ⌚ 13:00 → 14:00

Measurement, reporting, and verification (MRV) systems are essential not only for transparency, but also for guiding climate action implementation and accountability. Well-designed MRV systems support policy-making, track progress, and inform future investments. This panel discusses how countries are operationalizing MRV systems that serve both reporting obligations and implementation needs.

◆ Speakers



**Mohamed
Al Marri**

Head of MRV Section
Ministry of Environment and
Climate Change (MECC) – Qatar



Mr. Suh-Yong Chung

former Greenhouse Gas Inventory
& Research Center (GIR) advisor
Korea Environment Institute (KEI)
- Republic of Korea



**Ms. María del
Pilar Bueno**

Ministry of Environment
- Colombia



**Siti Nadia Nurul
Azizah**

Nature-based Solutions Specialist
Ministry of Environment and Forestry,



◆ Agenda

- 🗣️ Opening Remarks ————— 5 mins
- 🗣️ Panel Discussion ————— 40 mins
- 🗣️ Q&A session with audience ——— 10 mins
- 📋 Wrap-up and conclusion ————— 5 mins



◆ Side-Event 3

From Ambition to Action: Implementing NDCs in the Decisive Decade

Theme: Climate Finance and Implementation

📅 NOV. 14 2026 | ⌚ 13:00 → 14:00

As updated Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs) are submitted, attention is increasingly focused on implementation. Delivering NDC commitments requires strong coordination across sectors, clear policy frameworks, financing strategies, and monitoring systems. This panel discussion explores practical approaches to implementing NDCs and turning ambition into measurable results.

◆ Agenda

- 🗣️ Opening Remarks ————— 5 mins
- 🗣️ Panel Discussion ————— 40 mins
- 🗣️ Q&A session with audience ——— 10 mins
- 📄 Wrap-up and conclusion ————— 5 mins

◆ Speakers



**Baligh
Awad**

Climate Change Engineer
*Ministry of Environment and
Climate Change (MECC) – Qatar*



**Mr. Axel Michaelowa
(Switzerland)**

Senior Founding Partner
*Perspectives Climate
Group - Germany*



Dr. Elisabeth Türk

Director, Economic
Cooperation and Trade
*United Nations Economic Commission
for Europe (UNECE) – Europe, US, UK*



Yalchin Rafiyev

Lead Climate Negotiator and Lead
Negotiator for COP29 Presidency
*Ministry of Foreign Affairs
COP29 Presidency.*

◆ Side-Event 4

Data, Digitalization, and AI for Climate Implementation and Decision-Making

Theme: AI and Climate Technology

NOV. 16 2026 | 13:00 → 14:00

Data, digital platforms, and artificial intelligence are increasingly shaping how climate action is planned, implemented, and monitored. When applied responsibly, digital tools can enhance efficiency, improve decision-making, and strengthen accountability. This panel explores real-world applications, opportunities, and governance considerations related to digital and AI-enabled climate implementation.

◆ Speakers



**Mr. Mohamed
al Bader**

Head
Ministry of Environment and
Climate Change (MECC) – Qatar



**Ms. Zulfiya
Khazina**

NAP Project Manager
Global Green Growth
Institute (GGGI) – Global



Bernhard Kowatsch

Head, Innovation
Accelerator
World Food Programme
(WFP) – Germany



Sasha Luccioni

AI & Climate
Lead
Hugging Face - Canada

◆ Agenda

- Opening Remarks — 5 mins
- Panel Discussion — 40 mins
- Q&A session with audience — 10 mins
- Wrap-up and conclusion — 5 mins



◆ Side-Event 5

Challenges of National Communications Reporting for Developing Countries

Theme: National Collaboration

NOV. 18 2026 | 13:00 → 14:00

Developing countries face a range of challenges when preparing National Communications, particularly in meeting reporting obligations under the UNFCCC. These challenges can affect their ability to produce comprehensive, accurate, and timely reports on a regular basis.

This session will highlight practical experiences from different countries and explore ways to overcome common challenges, address existing gaps, strengthen technical capacities, and enhance the quality and comprehensiveness of National Communications reporting.

◆ Agenda

-  Opening Remarks ————— 5 mins
-  Panel Discussion ————— 40 mins
-  Q&A session with audience ——— 10 mins
-  Wrap-up and conclusion ————— 5 mins

◆ Speakers



**Mr. Oubay
M. Al-Khaznadar**
Climate Engineer
*Ministry of Environment and
Climate Change (MECC) – Qatar*



Ms. Jessica Troni
Senior Programme Officer,
Head of Adaptation Unit.
*United Nations Environment
Programme (UNEP)*



**Pradeep
Kurukulasuriya**
Executive Coordinator,
Climate Promise
UNDP - Sri Lank



**Prof. Dr. Barış
Karapınar**
Climate Policy Expert; IPCC
Lead Author (AR5)
IPCC, UN climate processes - Turkey



Speakers



H.E. Dr. Abdullah bin Abdulaziz bin Turki Al Subaie
Minister of Environment and Climate Change
Ministry of Environment and Climate Change (MECC) – Qatar



H.E. Bahilit Lahadalia
Minister of Ecology and Mineral Resources
Ministry of Energy and Mineral Resources – Indonesia



H.E. Yerlan Nyssanbayev
Minister of Ecology and Natural Resources
Ministry of Ecology and Natural Resources – Kazakhstan



Eng. Ahmed Mohamed Al Sada
Assistant Undersecretary for Climate Change Affairs
Ministry of Environment and Climate Change (MECC) – Qatar



H.E. Sang-Hyup Kim
Executive Director
Global Green Growth Institute (GGGI) – South Korea



Mrs. Cyiza Beatrice
Permanent Secretary
Ministry of Environment Rwanda



Eng. Saad Al Hitmi
Director of Climate Change Department
Ministry of Environment and Climate Change (MECC) – Qatar



Eng. Mahmoud al Marwani
Assistant Director of Climate Change Department
Ministry of Environment and Climate Change (MECC) – Qatar



Ms. Maria del Pilar Bueno
Ministry of Environment – Colombia



Mr. Mohamed al Bader
Head
Ministry of Environment and Climate Change (MECC) – Qatar



Mr. Saud al Shamhari
Engineer
Ministry of Environment and Climate Change (MECC) – Qatar



Ms. Jessica Troni
Senior Programme Officer, Head of Adaptation Unit,
United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)



Dr. Gonzalo Castro de la Mata
Executive Director
Earthna Qatar



Mr. John Verdieck
Director of Climate Policy
The Nature Conservancy (TNC) – US



Baligh Awad
Climate Change Engineer
Ministry of Environment and Climate Change (MECC) – Qatar



Mr. Aymane doukali
Head, Structured Finance
Qatar Financial Center (QFC) – Qatar



Ms. Jen Turner
Energy Director
Equitable Origin USA



Mr. Suh-Yong Chung
former Greenhouse Gas Inventory & Research Center (GIR) advisor
Korea Environment Institute (KEI) – Republic of Korea



Mr. Andrea Bonzanni
International Policy Director
IETA Switzerland



Ms. Masha'al Abdulla Al-Obaidli
Sr. Facility Engineer
QatarEnergy Qatar



Dr. Elisabeth Türk
Director, Economic Cooperation and Trade
United Nations Economic Commission for Europe (UNECE) – Europe, US, UK



Ms. Saule Sabieva
Director of Climate Policy
Ministry of Ecology and Natural Resources – Kazakhstan



Ms. Zulfia Khazina
NAP Project Manager
Global Green Growth Institute (GGGI) – Global



Mohamed Al Marri
Head of MRV Section
Ministry of Environment and Climate Change (MECC) – Qatar



Mr. Axel Michaelowa
(Switzerland)
Senior Foundation Partner
Perspectives Climate Group – Germany



Mr. Oubay M. Al-Khaznadar
Climate Engineer
Ministry of Environment and Climate Change (MECC) – Qatar



Ms. Fatma Varank
Deputy Minister



Ms. Rohini Kohli
UNDP



Yalchin Rafiyev
Lead Climate Negotiator and Lead Negotiator for COP29 Presidency
Ministry of Foreign Affairs
COP29 Presidency.



Pradeep Kurukulasuriya
Executive Coordinator, Climate Promise
UNDP – Sri Lanka



Prof. Dr. Barış Karapınar
Climate Policy Expert; IPCC Lead Author (AR5)
IPCC, UN climate processes – Turkey



Bernhard Kowatsch
Head, Innovation Accelerator
World Food Programme (WFP) – Germany



Siti Nadia Nurul Azizah
Nature-based Solutions Specialist
Ministry of Environment and Forestry,



Sasha Luccioni
AI & Climate Lead
Hugging Face – Canada



QATAR
PAVILION
جناح قطر



COP31
Türkiye
ANTALYA

LEADING CLIMATE ACTION
FOR A SUSTAINABLE FUTURE



Scan to Visit
the MECC Website



وزارة البيئة والتغير المناخي
Ministry of Environment and Climate Change
الهيئة العامة للبيئة



Ministry of Environment and Climate Change
(MECC) State of Qatar , P.O. Box 24334, Doha, Qatar



+974 4420 7000



www.mecc.gov.qa

CONNECT WITH US



#Qatar_at_COP31